

## Inherent Vice: A Collaborative Infrastructure for Insurance as Governance

26 messages

Jefferson Richards &lt;jefferson@richards.plus&gt;

Wed, Apr 22, 2026 at 3:28 PM

To: Golda Velez <gvelez17@gmail.com>, Aaron Eden <aaron@aitrailblazers.org>, Maria Mascareno-Eden <maria@aitrailblazers.org>, Dave Guevara <daveg@complaxion.com>, "Mach, Alexandra - (amach)" <amach@arizona.edu>, "Varecka, Laurie A - (heide)" <heide@arizona.edu>, "George M. Belokas (GPWA)" <gbelokas@gpwa.com>, "Ulmer, Douglas L - (ulmer)" <ulmer@arizona.edu>, victoria.fimea@difi.az.gov, Geoffrey Smith <geoffreysmithabides@gmail.com>, Andy Littleton <andy@missionchurchtucson.com>

**Bottom Line Up Front (BLUF):** I propose a strategic coalition between our respective organizations to build a data-to-policy pipeline. By combining public API data, rapid software development, and academic risk analysis, we can provide the actuarial community with the tools necessary to make previously uninsurable risks insurable.

### Colleagues,

You are receiving this because you each hold a critical piece of a rapidly converging puzzle. While you may not all know each other personally, I have worked with each of your organizations and see a clear, actionable pathway to integrate our efforts.

We are entering an era of "Insurance as Governance." The proliferation of real-time data—from the NERIS fire incident API to ambient health sensors—allows us to shift risk management from historical guesswork to dynamic, continuous governance.

To capitalize on this, we need a pipeline:

1. **Raw Data:** Provided by platforms like [NERIS](#).
2. **Software Interfacing:** Developed rapidly through teams like [Linked Trust](#) to build the API connections and MCP servers.
3. **Risk Analysis:** Conducted by credentialed actuarial students ([University of Arizona: Risk Runners](#)) and AI educators ([AI Trailblazers](#)) applying ISO 31010 methodologies (see: [Simplified Lesson on ISO 31010](#)).
4. **Underwriting:** Delivered to the actuarial community to draft policies for previously uninsurable assets (e.g., fire-risk real estate, complex health profiles).
5. **(An important note here for the Academics and Actuaries:** I see the University of Arizona partnering with SOA, as ASU is so heavily intertwined with CAS. Students coming from high-school may lean more towards wanting to mitigate "complex health profiles" and choose UA, whereas those who lean towards "fire-risk real estate" could choose ASU. (See the attached org structure from 2019 when I started dreaming up a way for the University of Arizona to catch-up with ASU by offering actuarial science.))

I have attached a brief white paper, "*Inherent Vice & The Era of Insurance as Governance*," which outlines this conceptual framework and specific use cases. (Note: While I utilized AI to help synthesize these concepts from my dictated notes, the strategy and relationships detailed are genuine, and pre-meditated for years... it's that 10-year "Picasso napkin art" ;).

**My Role and My Ask:** I am writing to you as a servant leader. My primary commitment is currently as a Data Quality Engineer in the **Patient Generated Health Data (PGHD) program at the Department of Veterans Affairs**. Because my time is increasingly dedicated to the mission of Veteran health, I cannot indefinitely "carry the water" for this project. My role is to be the catalyst—to level the field so you can all see the noble and honest value each of your organizations brings to this bigger picture.

This vision isn't new to me; it is a legacy. I have spent the last ten years writing a book series on the intersection of **AI and Insurance as Governance**. I grew up apprenticing under my father, who worked in AI for the Department of Defense 35 years ago. He taught me a vital lesson that I carry into this syndicate: *despite the greed that inevitably follows information management systems, the fundamental fallacies of human observation persist*. We need this data pipeline not just for profit, but for truth and better governance.

My immediate goal is to secure funding for a pilot program focused specifically on the NERIS fire data. I will have a one-pager about this project ready for the **Arizona Captive Insurance Association** and the **Casualty Actuaries of the Desert States** events around May 20th-21st.

I would be remiss not to include the [Parables of Jesus](#) (at the cost of print, or attached) - unabridged and unannotated pure wisdom—as this vision doesn't fall into place without years of intimate prayer.

Best regards,

--  
Jefferson Richards  
R+ Owner/Manager  
520.981.3639  
[Book 30min with Jefferson](#)  
Website: [richards.plus](#)  
Profile: [jeffersonrichards.com](#)

### 3 attachments

-  **2026-04-22\_Inherent-Vice.pdf**  
322K
-  **The Parables of Jesus.pdf**  
332K
-  **2019-10-09\_RiskRunners\_Actuarial\_Org\_Strategy.pdf**  
47K

Golda Velez &lt;gvelez17@gmail.com&gt;

Thu, Apr 23, 2026 at 7:45 AM

To: Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus>, Kenechukwu Orjiene <orjienekenechukwu@gmail.com>

oh this is cool! ok we'll get that 1-pager to you this next week, anything else you need from our end?

[Quoted text hidden]

Aaron Eden &lt;aaron@aitrailblazers.org&gt;

Thu, Apr 23, 2026 at 7:56 AM

To: jefferson@richards.plus

Jefferson,

Thanks for the proposal and the broad framing.

Trying to understand fit: how do you see Inherent Vice connecting to AI Trailblazers specifically, or is it a separate project that happens to overlap in a few places?

My read so far is that the data pipeline and actuarial tooling side sounds closer to Brain Bridge (my consulting work) than to what we do at AITB, where the work is community education and workforce development. Want to make sure we point you toward the right partner.

Best,

Aaron Eden  
Co-Founder, AI Trailblazers  
Equipping, empowering and elevating our communities. AI for All.  
(520)360-7193

Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus>

Thu, Apr 23, 2026 at 8:11 AM

To: Aaron Eden <aaron@aitrailblazers.org>

Aaron,

You might be right that Brain Bridge is a more appropriate partner for building end-to-end pipelines from sensors to APIs to risk-reports to insurers (with the goal of insuring the uninsurable).

I aim to systemize the workforce development aspect of this pipeline maintenance, especially in the actuarial portion (RiskRunners.com), and I am here to help secure funding for pilot programs and illuminate how momentum is building towards Insurance as Governance.

Thanks for chiming in,

Jefferson

[Quoted text hidden]

Geoffrey Smith <geoffreysmithabides@gmail.com>

Thu, Apr 23, 2026 at 4:51 PM

To: Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus>

Cc: Golda Velez <gvelez17@gmail.com>, Aaron Eden <aaron@aitrailblazers.org>, Maria Mascareno-Eden <maria@aitrailblazers.org>, Dave Guevara <daveg@complaxion.com>, "Mach, Alexandra - (amach)" <amach@arizona.edu>, "Varecka, Laurie A - (heide)" <heide@arizona.edu>, "George M. Belokas (GPWA)" <gbelokas@gpwa.com>, "Ulmer, Douglas L - (ulmer)" <ulmer@arizona.edu>, victoria.fimea@difl.az.gov, Andy Littleton <andy@missionchurchtucson.com>

This is an idea whose time has come. I've had the honor to watch the synthesis of this work and for my part, I am all in on this. We are getting a rare glimpse of when form meets function guided by spirit.

On Wed, Apr 22, 2026 at 3:28 PM Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus> wrote:

[Quoted text hidden]

Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus>

Fri, Apr 24, 2026 at 6:15 AM

To: Golda Velez <gvelez17@gmail.com>

Cc: Kenechukwu Orjiene <orjienekenechukwu@gmail.com>

The one-pager will be sufficient, thank you!

[Quoted text hidden]

Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus>

Fri, Apr 24, 2026 at 6:18 AM

To: Geoffrey Smith <geoffreysmithabides@gmail.com>

Cc: Golda Velez <gvelez17@gmail.com>, Aaron Eden <aaron@aitrailblazers.org>, Maria Mascareno-Eden <maria@aitrailblazers.org>, Dave Guevara <daveg@complaxion.com>, "Mach, Alexandra - (amach)" <amach@arizona.edu>, "Varecka, Laurie A - (heide)" <heide@arizona.edu>, "George M. Belokas (GPWA)" <gbelokas@gpwa.com>, "Ulmer, Douglas L - (ulmer)" <ulmer@arizona.edu>, victoria.fimea@difl.az.gov, Andy Littleton <andy@missionchurchtucson.com>

Thanks Geoff,

The cause is setting up pipelines from: **sensors --> APIs --> risk reports --> policies**, to insure the uninsurable.

[Quoted text hidden]

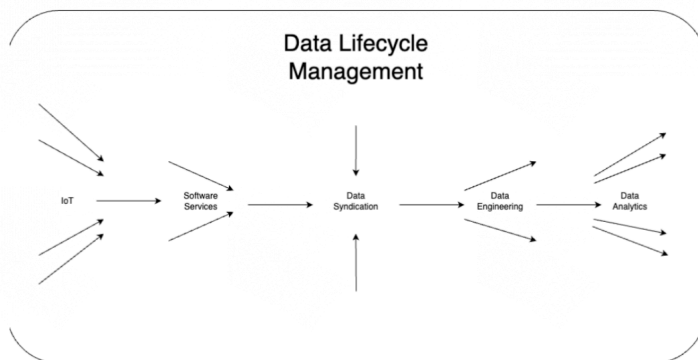
Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus>

Fri, Apr 24, 2026 at 6:39 AM

To: Geoffrey Smith <geoffreysmithabides@gmail.com>

Cc: Golda Velez <gvelez17@gmail.com>, Aaron Eden <aaron@aitrailblazers.org>, Maria Mascareno-Eden <maria@aitrailblazers.org>, Dave Guevara <daveg@complaxion.com>, "Mach, Alexandra - (amach)" <amach@arizona.edu>, "Varecka, Laurie A - (heide)" <heide@arizona.edu>, "George M. Belokas (GPWA)" <gbelokas@gpwa.com>, "Ulmer, Douglas L - (ulmer)" <ulmer@arizona.edu>, victoria.fimea@difl.az.gov, Andy Littleton <andy@missionchurchtucson.com>

to provide a visual:



[Quoted text hidden]

Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus>

Mon, Apr 27, 2026 at 7:39 AM

To: Geoffrey Smith <geoffreysmithabides@gmail.com>  
Cc: Golda Velez <gvelez17@gmail.com>, Aaron Eden <aaron@aitrailblazers.org>, Maria Mascareno-Eden <maria@aitrailblazers.org>, "Mach, Alexandra - (amach)" <amach@arizona.edu>, "Varecka, Laurie A - (heide)" <heide@arizona.edu>, "George M. Belokas (GPWA)" <gbelokas@gpwa.com>, "Ulmer, Douglas L - (ulmer)" <ulmer@arizona.edu>, victoria.fimea@difi.az.gov, Andy Littleton <andy@missionchurchtucson.com>

I want to show you all the proofs of concept developed from market feedback in Healthcare and Wealthcare:

The Fast Healthcare Interoperability Resources (FHIR) spec is a standard document structure that is changing Electronic Healthcare Recordkeeping (EHR) protocols. In healthcare, I have learned that predicting the test clinicians would recommend to their patients is better received and carries lower liability than claiming that AI can predict pathologies. Additionally, predicting follow-up tests (getting insurance approval) ensures there is an accredited "human-in-the-loop".

Lemme give an example:

The FHIR spec has a standard for [RiskAssessments](#) (see attached pic). These risk assessments aggregate biometric observations collected through the Internet of Things and clinical evaluations. My proof of concept shows that Healthcare could be decentralized - shifting the impetus of responsibility for healthcare to the Medical Power of Attorneys in each family. I extend this Proof of Concept to utilize the same data pipelines and software for governing the FHIR spec [from Healthcare to Wealthcare](#).

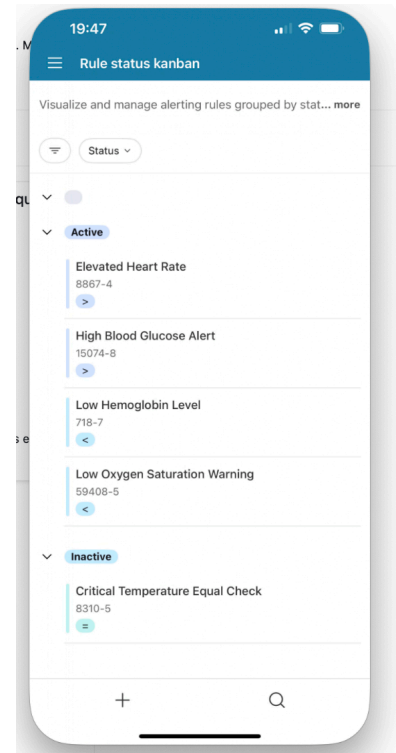
This is the "Data Syndication" part of the Data Lifecycle Management that can be teed up for the accredited Data Practitioner - a role that will emerge in society, especially in Healthcare. This shift will occur as our support teams need to focus on their respective roles (e.g. Dermatologist, Ear-Nose-Throat, Podiatrist), and Throat, Podiatrist) and as community interdependencies grow (i.e. as families grow). The need for **interoperability** among biometrics, risk assessments, and claims is growing, as is the need for a dedicated Data Doctor to take vested ownership of evaluating the various practitioners' data. And if the Data Doctor does not catch the health anomalies while a stream of data is coming through, who is liable? This pressure is relieved by designating a "family medic" to own the notifications and coordination of family healthcare.

Similarly, this can be set up for Family Wealthcare or Family Resource Management. As Aristotle points out, the skills for appropriating resources differ from those needed to manage WITH the resources brought into the household, which necessitates role specialization in family management.

Attached is a proof of concept and a couple of photos demonstrating how Risk Assessments could be visualized for the Family Medic or Family Wealthcare Manager.

Additionally, the Data Doctors need the ability to set thresholds for notifying stakeholders. Here is a snapshot of how that could look:

Sincerely,  
Jefferson



19:47

×

Elevated Heart Rate

Elevated Heart Rate

⊖

FHIR Observation Code

8867-4

Condition

>

Threshold Value

120

Units

bpm

Status

Active

Rule Description

Notifies if heart rate exceeds 120 bpm.

Edited by field agent

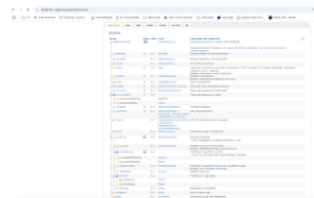
Rule Logic Formula

8867-4 > 120 bpm

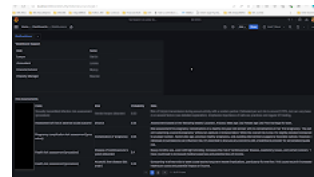
Is Active?

[Quoted text hidden]

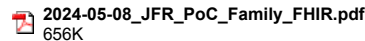
3 attachments



riskassessment.png  
226K



Healthcare-Wealthcare-RiskDash.png  
204K



2024-05-08\_JFR\_PoC\_Family\_FHIR.pdf  
656K

Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus> Mon, Apr 27, 2026 at 10:00 AM

To: Geoffrey Smith <geoffreysmithabides@gmail.com>

Cc: Golda Velez <gvelez17@gmail.com>, Aaron Eden <aaron@aitrailblazers.org>, Maria Mascareno-Eden <maria@aitrailblazers.org>, "Mach, Alexandra - (amach)" <amach@arizona.edu>, "Varecka, Laurie A - (heide)" <heide@arizona.edu>, "George M. Belokas (GPWA)" <gbelokas@gpwa.com>, "Ulmer, Douglas L - (ulmer)" <ulmer@arizona.edu>, victoria.fimea@difi.az.gov, Andy Littleton <andy@missionchurchtucson.com>

So, to wrap this up, and give you an option, the coalition I am proposing has the following Responsibility Assignment Matrix to implement what comes about:

Responsible:  
Jefferson (Integralmass.com)  
Golda (LinkedTrust)  
Aaron (Brain Bridge)

Accountable:  
Jefferson

Consulted:  
The Actuaries  
The Academic Leadership  
The Insurance Policymakers  
The Moral Elders

Informed:  
The AI Education nonprofit  
The Actuarial Students

Each group has representation here.

Give a "yay" or "nay" if you would like to continue to be a part of this coalition.

No response within 2 weeks is a "nay".

Peace,  
Jefferson

On Mon, Apr 27, 2026 at 07:39 Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus> wrote:  
I want to show you all the proofs of concept developed from market feedback in Healthcare and Wealthcare:

The Fast Healthcare Interoperability Resources (FHIR) spec is a standard document structure that is changing Electronic Healthcare Recordkeeping (EHR) protocols. In healthcare, I have learned that predicting the test clinicians would recommend to their patients is better received and carries lower liability than claiming that AI can predict pathologies. Additionally, predicting follow-up tests (getting insurance approval) ensures there is an accredited "human-in-the-loop".

[Quoted text hidden]  
[Quoted text hidden]

George M. Belokas (GPWA) <gbelokas@gpwa.com>  
To: Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus>

Mon, Apr 27, 2026

Hi Jefferson,

I don't think this opportunity is in my wheelhouse so will bow out. Hope the coalition is successful!

George

George M. Belokas, FCAS, MAAA  
President  
GPW and Associates, Inc.  
3101 North Central Avenue, Suite 400  
Phoenix, Arizona 85012  
Direct Line: (602)200-6939  
Cell: (480)239-4325



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**From:** Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus>  
**Sent:** Monday, April 27, 2026 10:01 AM  
**To:** Geoffrey Smith <geoffreysmithabides@gmail.com>  
**Cc:** Golda Velez <gvelez17@gmail.com>; Aaron Eden <aaron@aitrailblazers.org>; Maria Mascareno-Eden <maria@aitrailblazers.org>; Mach, Alexandra - (amach) <amach@arizona.edu>; Varecka, Laurie A - (heide) <heide@arizona.edu>; George M. Belokas (GPWA) <gbelokas@gpwa.com>; Ulmer, Douglas L - (ulmer) <ulmer@arizona.edu>; victoria.fimea@difi.az.gov; Andy Littleton <andy@missionchurchtucson.com>  
**Subject:** Re: Inherent Vice: A Collaborative Infrastructure for Insurance as Governance

EXTERNAL EMAIL - This email was sent by a person from outside your organization. Exercise caution when clicking links, opening attachments or taking further action, before validating its authenticity.

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19:47



## Rule status kanban

Visualize and manage alerting rules grouped by stat... [more](#)



Status ▾



### Active

Elevated Heart Rate

8867-4



High Blood Glucose Alert

15074-8



Low Hemoglobin Level

718-7



Low Oxygen Saturation Warning

59408-5



### Inactive

Critical Temperature Equal Check

8310-5



19:47



✕ Elevated Heart Rate



Elevated Heart Rate



FHIR Observation Code

8867-4

Condition



Threshold Value

120

Units

bpm

Status

Active

Rule Description

Notifies if heart rate exceeds 120 bpm.

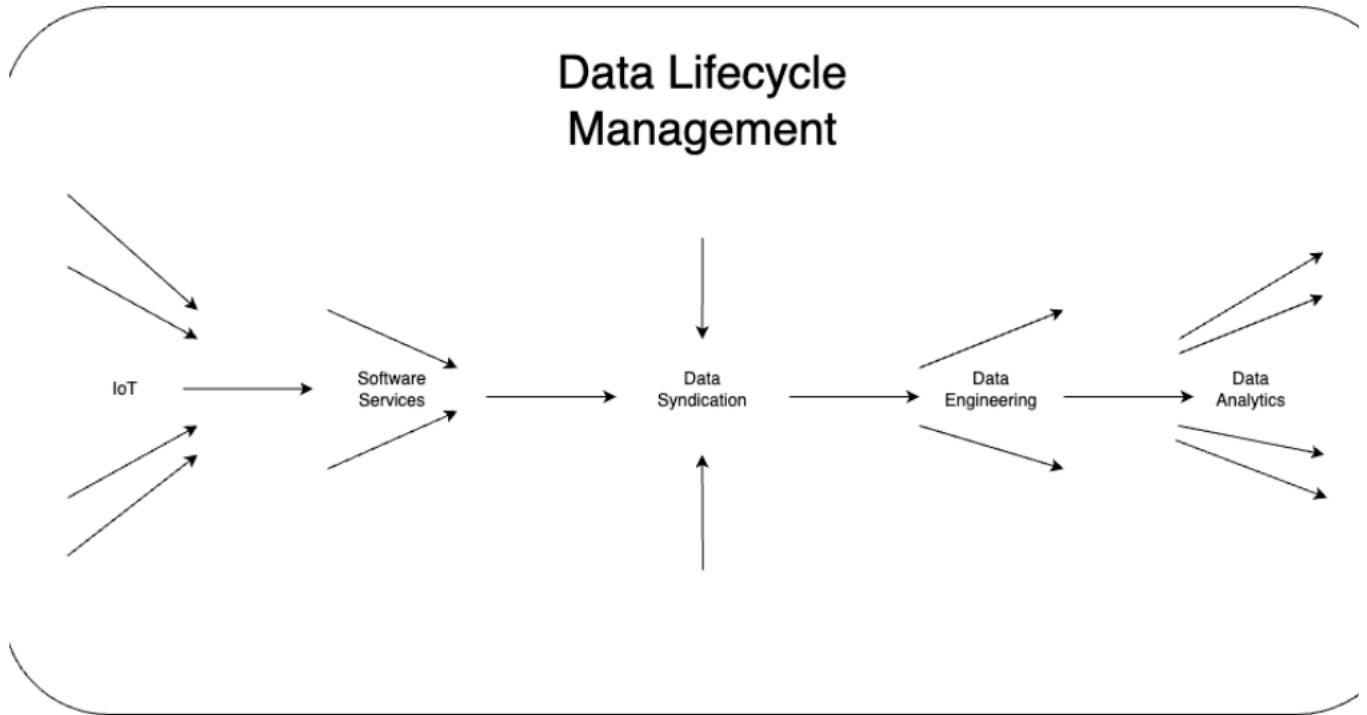
Edited by field agent

Rule Logic Formula

8867-4 > 120 bpm

Is Active?

to provide a visual:



[Quoted text hidden]

Jefferson  
[Quoted text hidden]

On Apr 27, 2026, at 10:00AM, Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus> wrote:

[Quoted text hidden]  
<healthcare-thresholds\_1.png>  
<healthcare\_thresholds\_2.png>

[Quoted text hidden]

hey I am in!



[Quoted text hidden]

**Mission Church** <andy@missionchurchtucson.com>  
To: Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus>

Tue, Apr 28, 2026 at 3:32 PM

Jefferson,

I have to admit that I am squeezing in these emails between a host of others and am feeling a bit like a fish out of water. Could you spell out (in layman's terms) how I would be helpful to this process and what I would do/how much I would do it? I lean toward saying I can't with all I have going, but the details above could change my mind and I definitely would value time with you and your/our friends doing something meaningful.

--



On Apr 27, 2026, at 10:00AM, Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus> wrote:

[Quoted text hidden]

[Quoted text hidden]

[Quoted text hidden]

<healthcare-thresholds\_1.png>

<healthcare\_thresholds\_2.png>

On Fri, Apr 24, 2026 at 6:39AM Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus> wrote:

to provide a visual:

<image.png>

[Quoted text hidden]

[Quoted text hidden]

**Ulmer, Douglas L - (ulmer)** <ulmer@arizona.edu>  
To: Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus>

Tue, Apr 28, 2026 at 5:13 PM

Happy to be consulted. -Doug

On Apr 27, 2026, at 10:00AM, Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus> wrote:

External Email

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[Quoted text hidden]

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<healthcare-thresholds\_1.png>

<healthcare\_thresholds\_2.png>

On Fri, Apr 24, 2026 at 6:39AM Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus> wrote:

to provide a visual:

<image.png>

[Quoted text hidden]

[Quoted text hidden]

**Jefferson Richards** <jefferson@richards.plus>

Tue, Apr 28, 2026 at 6:01 PM

To: Golda Velez <gvelez17@gmail.com>

Cc: Geoffrey Smith <geffreysmithabides@gmail.com>, Aaron Eden <aaron@aitrailblazers.org>, Maria Mascareno-Eden <maria@aitrailblazers.org>, "Mach, Alexandra - (amach)" <amach@arizona.edu>, "Varecka, Laurie A - (heide)" <heide@arizona.edu>, "Ulmer, Douglas L - (ulmer)" <ulmer@arizona.edu>, victoria.fimea@diff.az.gov, Andy Littleton <andy@missionchurchtucson.com>

Hello everyone,

I wanted to send a quick update on the response to the proposed coalition to "Insure the Uninsurable."

First, the good news! We have received "Yays" from almost all representative groups I reached out to:

- **Responsible/Accountable:** Golda (Link Trust), Aaron (Brain Bridge), and myself (IntegralMass).
- **Consulted:** Academic Leadership (Doug has graciously agreed) and one of our Moral Elders (Geoff).
- **Informed:** AI Education Nonprofit (Maria is on board).

This is a fantastic start. Regarding the Actuaries, I received a "nay," but I view that positively—it means we now know exactly what expertise we need to seek out to complete the matrix.

One of our other proposed "Moral Elders," Andy, sent me an insightful email asking for role clarity. His questions were so good that I think the answers benefit everyone in this coalition.

Andy asked, in layman's terms:

- 1. How would he be helpful to this process?
- 2. What exactly would he do?
- 3. And how much would he do it?

He also mentioned that while he is incredibly busy, he values time spent with friends doing something meaningful.

Here is the answer I want to share with everyone, specifically regarding the role of "Moral Elder" (the "C" or Consulted in our matrix).

In layman's terms, the cause is this: To insure the uninsurable.

We are looking to use data—specifically from the "Internet of Things" (IoT), like sensors—to better understand risks, starting with a pilot program regarding fire risk (NERIS).

However, the bigger vision is that we are moving into an era of **Insurance as Governance**. We must face a critical ethical question: If sensors can monitor our every move, should insurance premiums be allowed to regulate our human values?

The specific "How" and "What" for Moral Elders like Andy:

I need Moral Elders, alongside Insurance Policymakers and Educators, to provide the ethical underpinning for this operation. I need you to consult us (the responsible parties implementing the data tech) for wisdom and direction so that this technology doesn't lead to a dystopian future.

Andy is currently writing what I believe is a very important book on the nature of **Friendship**. He expressed that he values meaningful work with friends.

So, here is my specific "Ask" for Andy: *Keep writing your book on friendship.*

As we implement these technical solutions, I plan to send occasional scenarios and allegories outlining how AI and IoT monitoring might impact society. Andy, I am asking you to *read these allegories* through the lens of your work on Friendship. I would value a simple sanity check from you along the way: *How does Friendship survive—or change—in a world where insurance dictates behavior through constant monitoring?*

That is the level of effort. It is low-touch consulting to ensure we never lose sight of the human element.

Thank you again to everyone who has agreed to this meaningful work. I look forward to trailblazing this path with you.

Peace,

Jefferson

[Quoted text hidden]

Geoffrey Smith <geoffreysmithabides@gmail.com> Thu, Apr 30, 2026 at 4:40 AM

To: Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus>  
Cc: Golda Velez <gvelez17@gmail.com>, Aaron Eden <aaron@aitrailblazers.org>, Maria Mascareno-Eden <maria@aitrailblazers.org>, Alexandra Mach <amach@arizona.edu>, Laurie A Varecka <heide@arizona.edu>, Douglas L Ulmer <ulmer@arizona.edu>, victoria.fimea@difi.az.gov, Andy Littleton <andy@missionchurchtucson.com>

I'm in a lonely airport at 4am and can't stop my mind from wonder at the possibility of insurance as governance. Not to be heavy handed here but I see this path as essential to be guided by thoughtful, caring and curious people. This path could devolve into the counter balance of Polymarket if it weren't for the love displayed through tension required to guide intermediate steps toward virtue.

Thank you Jefferson for leading from virtue and pointing us toward holiness. Your structure and team building reflect that priority. Keep going

On Apr 28, 2026, at 6:01 PM, Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus> wrote:

[Quoted text hidden]  
[Quoted text hidden]  
hey I am in!  
[Quoted text hidden]  
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On Fri, Apr 24, 2026 at 6:39 AM Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus> wrote:  
to provide a visual:  
<image.png>  
[Quoted text hidden]  
[Quoted text hidden]

Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus> Sun, May 3, 2026 at 4:59 PM

To: Geoffrey Smith <geoffreysmithabides@gmail.com>  
Cc: Golda Velez <gvelez17@gmail.com>, Aaron Eden <aaron@aitrailblazers.org>, Maria Mascareno-Eden <maria@aitrailblazers.org>, Alexandra Mach <amach@arizona.edu>, Laurie A Varecka <heide@arizona.edu>, Douglas L Ulmer <ulmer@arizona.edu>, victoria.fimea@difi.az.gov, Andy Littleton <andy@missionchurchtucson.com>

I hear you Geoff, and encourage your evaluation of a futarchy for us:  
<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Futarchy?wprov=sfti1>

is our current social fabric antifrangible enough to handle banal polymarkets? (without scaring us)

Json

[Quoted text hidden]

Golda Velez <gvelez17@gmail.com> Sun, May 3, 2026 at 5:05 PM

To: Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus>  
Cc: Geoffrey Smith <geoffreysmithabides@gmail.com>, Aaron Eden <aaron@aitrailblazers.org>, Maria Mascareno-Eden <maria@aitrailblazers.org>, Alexandra Mach <amach@arizona.edu>, Laurie A Varecka <heide@arizona.edu>, Douglas L Ulmer <ulmer@arizona.edu>, victoria.fimea@difi.az.gov, Andy Littleton <andy@missionchurchtucson.com>

Ah - maybe not the best time for it :-). I think focusing on smaller cooperative enterprises that grow organically is good, and at the large scale i think the big missing piece is having value for every life regardless of nationality, there are some pretty huge gaping holes in current systems of value globally. But focusing on growing bottom up with voice and value for all team members, I'm all in.

[Quoted text hidden]

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**Jefferson Richards** <jefferson@richards.plus>

Sun, May 3, 2026 at 5:18 PM

To: Golda Velez <gvelez17@gmail.com>

Cc: Geoffrey Smith <geoffreysmithabides@gmail.com>, Aaron Eden <aaron@aitrailblazers.org>, Maria Mascareno-Eden <maria@aitrailblazers.org>, Alexandra Mach <amach@arizona.edu>, Laurie A Varecka <heide@arizona.edu>, Douglas L Ulmer <ulmer@arizona.edu>, victoria.fimea@difi.az.gov, Andy Littleton <andy@missionchurchtucson.com>

thank you, Golda

yes, I have given much credence to your approach at valuing life and labor, and have come to ESOPs as a next place of inquiry.

I haven't quite looked it up, but I thought there was a Banana Growers situation (in Belize?) that contributed to ESOP precedent...

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**Golda Velez** <gvelez17@gmail.com>

Sun, May 3, 2026 at 5:23 PM

To: Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus>

Cc: Geoffrey Smith <geoffreysmithabides@gmail.com>, Aaron Eden <aaron@aitrailblazers.org>, Maria Mascareno-Eden <maria@aitrailblazers.org>, Alexandra Mach <amach@arizona.edu>, Laurie A Varecka <heide@arizona.edu>, Douglas L Ulmer <ulmer@arizona.edu>, victoria.fimea@difi.az.gov, Andy Littleton <andy@missionchurchtucson.com>



Golda Velez reacted via [Gmail](#)

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**Golda Velez** <gvelez17@gmail.com>

Sun, May 3, 2026 at 5:24 PM

To: Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus>

Cc: Geoffrey Smith <geoffreysmithabides@gmail.com>, Aaron Eden <aaron@aitrailblazers.org>, Maria Mascareno-Eden <maria@aitrailblazers.org>, Alexandra Mach <amach@arizona.edu>, Laurie A Varecka <heide@arizona.edu>, Douglas L Ulmer <ulmer@arizona.edu>, victoria.fimea@difi.az.gov, Andy Littleton <andy@missionchurchtucson.com>

Yes - there are several models emerging - I will be speaking again this year at Ownership Economy conference in NYC - <https://summit2026.ownershipconomy.com/registration>. ESOPs are indeed ones of them, alongside platform cooperatives, traditional cooperatives, and our Earned Governance model for startups. Not sure how interested all on this list are in the details but yes this is core!

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**Jefferson Richards** <jefferson@richards.plus>

Sun, May 3, 2026 at 5:26 PM

To: Golda Velez <gvelez17@gmail.com>

Cc: Geoffrey Smith <geoffreysmithabides@gmail.com>, Aaron Eden <aaron@aitrailblazers.org>, Maria Mascareno-Eden <maria@aitrailblazers.org>, Alexandra Mach <amach@arizona.edu>, Laurie A Varecka <heide@arizona.edu>, Douglas L Ulmer <ulmer@arizona.edu>, victoria.fimea@difi.az.gov, Andy Littleton <andy@missionchurchtucson.com>

let's put that "in the parking lot"

next on the docket is the Arizona Captive Insurance Association and Casualty Actuaries of the Desert States meetings on May 20th and 21st.

AZCIA on the 20th is hybrid, and I am thinking to attend virtually (though I am signed up in person) as the environment is intimate and I have already "came in hot" with a group who are oriented toward maintaining and propagating Captive Insurance structures.

I have documented the Captives I have been trying to start - here:

<https://captive.integralmass.com>

<https://dental.riskrunners.com>

Golda+Kene prepared a 1 pager about the NERIS project - which is the pilot program we are aiming to fund.

Golda, are you okay with me sharing that here?

I think it looks good.

Thanks,  
Jefferson

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**Golda Velez** <gvelez17@gmail.com>

Sun, May 3, 2026 at 5:46 PM

To: Jefferson Richards <jefferson@richards.plus>

Cc: Geoffrey Smith <geoffreysmithabides@gmail.com>, Aaron Eden <aaron@aitrailblazers.org>, Maria Mascareno-Eden <maria@aitrailblazers.org>, Alexandra Mach <amach@arizona.edu>, Laurie A Varecka <heide@arizona.edu>, Douglas L Ulmer <ulmer@arizona.edu>, victoria.fimea@difi.az.gov, Andy Littleton <andy@missionchurchtucson.com>

agreed! and yes please share!

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**Jefferson Richards** <jefferson@richards.plus>

Sun, May 3, 2026 at 5:51 PM

To: Golda Velez <gvelez17@gmail.com>

Cc: Geoffrey Smith <geoffreysmithabides@gmail.com>, Aaron Eden <aaron@aitrailblazers.org>, Maria Mascareno-Eden <maria@aitrailblazers.org>, Alexandra Mach <amach@arizona.edu>, Laurie A Varecka <heide@arizona.edu>, Douglas L Ulmer <ulmer@arizona.edu>, victoria.fimea@difi.az.gov, Andy Littleton <andy@missionchurchtucson.com>

Attached is the NERIS Pilot one-pager, nicknamed: Project Crucible

...

Once these two weeks are up, and we have our "yays" or de facto "nays"  
We could vote on our team name being "The Crucible Coalition".

That's just a future motion ;)

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